

Couples consisting of two changelings or a Kithain and an enchanted human have a much easier time of parenting, both able to perceive the Dreaming, and able to work as a team to ensure mundane people don't think anything odd of their offspring.

Childhood

By the time a Kinain is ready to enter school, she's probably had the unfortunate need for secrecy pounded into her head hard enough that she won't start interacting with something that can't be seen or heard by her mundane teachers and classmates. Many Kinain children, like their parents when they were younger, withdraw into the Dreaming and avoid mundane reality in favor of the wonders that go unseen to the mortal eye.

In spite what some conservative Freeholds may wish, changelings fresh from their Chrysalis are often drawn to Kinain of their own age. Finding someone with one foot in their new world and one foot in the old one is a boon few would turn down, and lifelong friendships can develop from such bonds. This is also, likely, the child's first introduction into the world of the fae without her parents by her side. Whether that is good or bad depends on a great many things, but in most cases these friendships are thought well of by both the newly-reincarnated Kithain's peers and the Kinain's parents.

Childhood is also when Kinain begin to experiment with their very limited supply of cantrips. Giving their restrictions on fae magic (p. 460) and a meager supply of Glamour that refreshes slowly, these experiments don't tend to go very far, and one who doesn't practice often finds herself outclassed by her peers rapidly. Much of their teaching is done by their fae parent, of course, though it is not unknown to seek out other tutors to augment studies into Glamour-weaving.

Teenage to Young Adult

As a Kinain child enters her teenage years, the limitations of her innate humanity become more obvious. While time spent in the Dreaming may limit her aging, the dangers and chaos therein limit how much she can take advantage of this, while the Kithain can take full advantage of the Dreaming's age-halting effects. A Kinain girl that made friends with a pooka boy in elementary school could find herself entering adolescence while he has only aged half the years of his half-mortal friend. Kinain often find themselves "babysitting" such friends until time spent outside the Dreaming catches them up. A generation gap where there once was none, no matter how small, can put a strain on their friendship, at which point, to protect the childling, older Kithain tend to reward her loyalty to the Fae. Payment in favors or services that would otherwise be off-limits to mortals, Kinain or otherwise, is common when things become strained. For the staunchest friendships, or for friends of wealthy, powerful, or even noble Kithain, rewards may be glamourspun outfits and trinkets, the most prized of which are overlaid onto stylish mundane clothes and popular accessories or electronic devices of the time, and therefore useful in both aspects of her life. Such boons are rare, but so is

the 16-year-old that remains friends with someone who's still 13, despite sharing a birthday with them.

Friendships with changelings that have aged normally (more or less) are generally more stable. While a fae-blooded's Kithain friends may become aware of their mortal pal's magical shortcomings, such frustrations rarely come to anything. In addition, her immunity to the Mists makes up for any limitations in the cantrip department. Someone that can handle the exceptionally mundane on the group's behalf is almost as valuable to a motley of teenagers as an adult willing to buy beer.

It's easy to generalize a Kinain's relationship with her parents as strained, like all teenagers, but the awkwardness of dealing with one's parents is exponentially multiplied by the addition of the Dreaming. A fae parent in Bedlam is ill fit to provide for her daughter, and on the other end of the spectrum, being Undone is a serious risk, as a newly-mortal parent may suddenly find herself painfully distanced from her daughter. Dealing with one mortal parent is bad enough, but even in their most heated conflicts, the bond between a changeling and her Kinain child is unbreakable. Losing that connection would be agonizing on a level that can't be put into words, and that's exactly what happens when Banality takes the parent. The problem of having two changelings for parents is apparent here. A Kinain could be left with one to grieve with, or be forced to watch as she loses both her parents. Such situations create runaways that spend as much time with their Kithain friends as possible. Most denizens of the Dreaming are more than receptive in such tragic situations, gladly putting the poor "orphan" up until she can accept what's happened.

Even if a Kinain teenager manages to dodge the bullet of watching a parent go through being Undone or falling to Bedlam, she's faced with all the troubles of becoming a young adult, on top of the often times convoluted world of the Dreaming. Often, she may forsake one entirely for the other for a time, but such escapism isn't healthy, and her friends and family will do their best to keep her focused on both worlds, for all the good that does.

Adulthood and Old Age

As Kinain age, their relationships with their fae parents shift. Changelings require more contact with the Dreaming as they age, as Banality seeps ever deeper into their souls. Kinain, of course, are immune to this slow decay, but too much contact with the Dreaming puts them at great risk.

If a Kinain has stayed with one freehold for most of her life, she can take on responsibilities too Banal to risk losing one of their own to. She might tend to the mundane responsibilities of keeping up a piece of property — while some changelings can handle the numbing bureaucracy of property taxes and homeowners' associations, most would prefer to leave that to a Kinain son or daughter. The nobility are in charge, of course, but even they don't mind ceding certain responsibilities to those better suited to handle them. No king, changeling or mortal, does his own taxes.

Balancing the mundane world and the fae world is harder when the mundane world means a job, a home, friends, and